

though the periscope lens is gone, the 50MP telephoto sensor does an amazing job. Whether in daylight or low light, it captures stunning pictures. And here's a pro tip: if you're getting this phone, use the portrait mode at 100mm, the shots will look very cinematic.

The shutter speed is very impressive, which helps capture moving objects nicely, especially in city lights kind of settings.

And even though the portrait mode's edge detection isn't perfect but with the right frame and some patience, you can take portraits like these as well with the iQOO 13.

FEATURES

Let's talk about its design now. After using the iQOO 12, I can confidently say that the in-hand feel of the iQOO 13 is exactly the same. In fact, one time, I woke up half-asleep and started using this phone thinking it was the iQOO 12 for a while.

It has a flat display like last year and a glass back. I have the Legend colour with BMW stripes, there's one more colour – Nardo Grey. Apart from colour, there is one more difference between these variants. The back of Legend has a matte finish, whereas Nardo Grey features a glossy back. Personally, I found the in-hand feel of Legend better. Now don't think that I am using Legend that's why I am saying it. I used the Nardo Grey for my video review which you can find below. From the back, it looks quite similar too, with the same camera module, but there are some fancy tweaks. Speaking of which, the most unique feature of the iQOO 13 is also, in my opinion, the most useless one. I am talking about the "Monster Halo" light that surrounds the camera module. These are RGB LED lights that you can find as 'Dynamic Light' in the iQOO 13.

They don't serve much purpose except for showing alerts and notifications. But if I'm honest, here's my real experience: alerts and notifications are typically obvious from the tone itself. Even in a rare scenario—let's say your phone is face-down, on silent, and it's dark in the room—you can still know about notifications thanks to vibrations. Vibrations are so strong nowadays that I hardly need

my phone to ring. So, this is a very fancy but practically useless feature. The lights are placed near the camera, but they have nothing to do with it. Many people try to find this feature in the camera app, but iQOO has tucked it away in the Settings. Just search for "Dynamic Light," and you'll find it easily.

For protection, the phone has two things going for it. One good thing is that it comes with IP68 and IP69 ratings, so it's built for rough use. However, when it comes to glass protection, there's nothing, unfortunately. So yeah, feel free to expose it to dust and water, but don't drop it.

Other than that, the in-hand feel and overall design are fine. The grip is a little less grippy, but it's not a big issue for someone with big hands like me. But if you have tiny hands, it might feel a little bulky.

DISPLAY

Its display may not be the brightest, but it is a pure luxury. The word "luxury" connects with comfort, and this display is genuinely comfortable for your eyes. iQOO calls it an Ultra Eye Care Display because it's built with a polarized sheet. This makes the display appear slightly warm, and warm colors are gentler on your eyes. That's a luxury for you!

However, this feature does have an impact on display performance. While it works great indoors, under sunlight, it feels a bit dim compared to other flagship devices. While testing its brightness with Luxmeter (a device to measure brightness), we got 1483 nits of recorded peak brightness. I think this could be better. Other than that, everything is top-notch. It features a 6.82-inch 144Hz 2K LTPO AMOLED display with exceptional responsiveness and sharpness. Moreover, the software on the iQOO 13 feels fresh, vibrant, and unmistakably Chinese. By 'Chinese,' I mean that, despite being marketed as a flagship, the iQOO 13 is cluttered with unnecessary apps (bloatware). iQOO, if you're reading this, we really don't need games like Rolling Twins and Block Blast.

BATTERY

A high-quality display like this naturally demands a solid battery to match, and

iQOO has delivered a 6000mAh battery. But what's even more impressive is that it charges from 0 to 100% in just 40 minutes, and this is legit lightning-fast for a battery this big, thanks to the 120-watt fast charging. As for battery consumption, here's an example: a 30-minute BGMI chicken dinner match uses only about 4-5% battery, which is an excellent figure. However, one thing could be better, which is the standby battery. I feel it has a good amount of overnight battery consumption.

VERDICT

So, how is the iQOO 13 as a phone? Should you go for it or not? With the GT 7 Pro in competition, should you prefer that instead? As a smartphone, I really liked the iQOO 13. It's a true performance phone, no doubt, with some additional features that you won't mind having.

Ultimately, it all comes down to one thing: money. The iQOO 13 has arrived in India for Rs 54,999. This pricing is less than we expected, and it also makes iQOO 13 the most affordable smartphone with the Snapdragon 8 Elite processor. This also means that if you are considering the Realme GT 7 Pro, keep in mind that the iQOO 13 is cheaper. So, my friends, the iQOO 13 might not be the best camera smartphone but it is surely the best performance or gaming phone under Rs 60,000. Period.

—Mustafa Khan

SPECIFICATIONS

Dimensions: 7.671cm (76.71mm) * 16.337cm (163.37mm) * 0.813cm (8.13mm) | Processor: Snapdragon® 8 Elite Mobile Platform | Size: 17.32cm (6.82-inch) | Camera: Rear: 50MP Sony IMX921 (1/1.56" Sony VCS TrueColor Camera) + 50 MP (1/2.76" Ultra Wide-Angle) + 50MP Sony IMX 816 (1/2.93" 2X Telephoto) | Front: 32MP | Weight: 213g | RAM: 12 GB | 16 GB | Resolution: 3168 * 1440 | Aperture: Rear: 50MP f/1.88 main Camera + 50MP f/2.0 ultra wide + 50MP f/1.85 telephoto | Front: f/2.45 | Back Material: Nardo Grey: Enamel Glass | Legend: AG Glass | ROM: 256 GB | 512 GB | Type: AMOLED | Flash: Screen Spotlight available | Battery: 6000mAh Type, Fast Charging 120W

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